



## STATUS REPORT

# Guinea-Bissau: status report

Edition of 2026-08-14 · 21 systems and instruments tracked, 1 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-14 from the Data Landscapers source base, from [outputs/reports/GNB/ledger.csv](#) (21 systems and instruments, 1 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

**Status values.** *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

## Summary of position

Guinea-Bissau is assembling the basics of a digital state largely through donor-driven projects, on an infrastructure base that still lacks a national fibre backbone: international connectivity runs through a single 2023 submarine-cable landing ([ACE](#)) and, since June 2025, [Starlink](#), while the World Bank-financed [WARDIP-GB backbone](#) (a 2,877 km design) remains in development, its own governing final report not held. Two threads dominate the record: civil-registration and identity digitisation — SIREC's piloted registry digitisation, Semlex's 18-centre biometric-ID production network, and a field-issued ECOWAS biometric card (ENBIC) — and a 2025–26 governance and legislative build-out: a national data-governance and protection policy, a cybersecurity strategy, an interoperability regulation and a revised Electronic Communications Law, all approved by decree but none confirmed gazetted, alongside an [Enacted "digital integrity" law](#) against online falsehoods that the government has already invoked once. The country's first fully digital census ([RGPH4](#)) put the population at 2,191,202 in July 2026. Financing is substantial relative to the size of the base: a US\$60.5m World Bank IDA grant, a US\$25.4m MIGA guarantee behind Orange Bissau, and a US\$3.36m UNDP grant.

## Infrastructure

### Connectivity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                 | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">ACE (Africa Coast to Europe) submarine cable landing</a> | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Guinea-Bissau connects to its first international submarine fibre-optic cable (ACE) |
| <a href="#">Starlink satellite internet service</a>                  | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Commercial launch                                                                   |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                        | STATUS ↗ source  | MILESTONE                                                                               |
|---------------------------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| WARDIP-GB National Fibre-Optic Backbone     | IN DEVELOPMENT ↗ | EIASS environmental and social safeguards study published, moving toward implementation |
| RNEP-GB / WARDIP-GB Final Report (Apr 2025) | NOT HELD         | —                                                                                       |

Guinea-Bissau's international connectivity rests on a single submarine-cable landing — the ACE cable, live since March 2023 — supplemented since June 2025 by [Starlink's commercial satellite service](#), its 7th West African market. A national fibre backbone is still in development: the World Bank-financed [WARDIP-GB programme](#), launched in April 2025, has published a 2,877 km/56-node design and an environmental and social safeguards study, but the project's own governing Final Report is not held in the base, leaving the design specifics resting on an undated project-website primary.

## Digital public infrastructure

### Data Exchange

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                       | STATUS ↗ source  | MILESTONE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Interoperability Regulation (public/private digital systems and platforms) | IN DEVELOPMENT ↗ | Council of Ministers approves a draft decree on the Regulation on Interoperability of Digital Systems and Platforms for Public and Private Services, alongside separate draft decrees on a National Data Governance and Protection Policy and a National Cybersecurity Strategy |

### Digital Identity and CRVS

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ENBIC (ECOWAS biometric ID) - Guinea-Bissau deployment | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | 262 women cross-border traders receive ENBIC cards in Sao Domingos (Cacheu) under a Guinea-Bissau-Senegal women-traders mobility pilot run by the National Borders Commission, ECOWAS-backed and GIZ-financed                    |
| Semlex biometric national-ID production network        | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Semlex opens a production centre in Safim (Biombo) - the third in Biombo, 100 cards per day - bringing the national network to 18 biometric-ID production centres; further centres planned for Sao Domingos and Bolama (Bijagos) |

### Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                               | STATUS ↗ source  | MILESTONE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SIREC (Integrated System of Citizen Registers and Statistics)                      | PILOTING ↗       | Ministry of Justice Civil Registration Office (Raul Gomes) describes SIREC digitizing births, deaths and marriages, with UNDP-trained officers, roughly three months into rollout; birth registration remains below 50% (~46% of under-fives)          |
| UNDP Building National ID project (civil-registry books scanning and digitization) | IN DEVELOPMENT ↗ | UNDP project, co-financed by the Swiss Confederation, sets up a digitization centre and develops software to recover and digitize paper civil-registry books (births, deaths, marriages, annotations) as the country's main national identity platform |

## National statistics

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| RGPH4 (4th General Population and Housing Census) | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | INE releases RGPH4 preliminary results - population 2,191,202 (up from 1,449,230 in 2009), the country's first fully digital (CAPI) census, financed by UNFPA (lead technical agency) and the World Bank |

Civil-registration and identity digitisation is the most advanced thread: [SIREC](#), piloted since roughly March 2025, is digitising births, deaths and marriages with UNDP-trained officers, against a birth-registration rate for under-fives still around 46%; [Semlex's biometric national-ID production network](#) has grown to 18 centres nationwide, most recently a third Biombo centre at Safim; and the ECOWAS biometric card ([ENBIC](#)), already operationalised nationally, saw its first reported field issuance — 262 cards to women cross-border traders in São Domingos — in March 2026. A separate [UNDP project](#) is digitising the paper civil-registry books that underlie all of this. The country's first fully digital census, [RGPH4](#), released preliminary results in July 2026 putting the population at 2,191,202. An [interoperability regulation](#) for public and private digital systems was approved by Council of Ministers decree in July 2025 but its promulgation is not confirmed. Guinea-Bissau's electronic-money footprint remains thin regionally — 1.94% of UEMOA accounts opened, via just two issuing initiatives, though active accounts grew 33.28% in 2024.

## Governance and regulation

### Cybersecurity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | STATUS ↗ source  | MILESTONE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------------------------------------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| National Cybersecurity and Data Protection Agency | PLANNED ↗        | Government presented WARDIP/NRD Cyber Security feasibility study results and committed to create a National Cybersecurity and Data Protection Agency (Minister Marciano Silva Barbeiro), framed as central to digital sovereignty and data protection |
| National Cybersecurity Strategy (decree)          | IN DEVELOPMENT ↗ | Council of Ministers approved the draft decree for a National Cybersecurity Strategy, following the January 2025 WARDIP/NRD Cyber Security feasibility study; no confirmation on file of gazettal or entry into force                                 |

### Legislation and regulation

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                       | STATUS ↗ source                                               | MILESTONE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Digital Integrity (Dissemination of False Information on the Internet) Law | ENACTED ↗                                                     | CNT (transitional parliament) unanimously passed, with amendments, the Law on the Dissemination of False Information on the Internet - framed by spokesman Fernando Vaz as targeting those who spread hate and act against the State; enforcement mechanisms, including for citizens abroad, left unstated |
| Electronic Communications Law (revised)                                    | UNDER REVIEW, COUNCIL OF MINISTERS APPROVED WITH AMENDMENTS ↗ | Council of Ministers approved, with amendments, a proposed Electronic Communications Law replacing the outdated 2010 telecom regime, under the transitional presidency of Horta Inta-a; not confirmed passed by the CNT or published/in force                                                              |

## Strategies, plans and policies

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                         | STATUS ↗ source  | MILESTONE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| National Digital Transformation Strategy 2025-2030 (ENTD.GW) | IN DEVELOPMENT ↗ | Strategy publicly launched (PM Rui Duarte Barros, Minister Marciano Silva Barbeiro, UNDP); 10 pillars, 6 objectives, 55 interventions, roadmap to 2030; Council of Ministers approval/decree still pending per the follow-up UNU-EGOV/UNDP meeting two days later |

## Regional collaboration

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                                       | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| AUDA-NEPAD Programme for African Developing Island Economies (Guinea-Bissau participation) | PLANNED ↗       | AUDA-NEPAD launched the Programme for African Developing Island Economies at the STC-TTIM Ministerial Segment in Abidjan, covering Guinea-Bissau among seven states; ministers adopted a communique committing to a 2026-2031 roadmap with six pillars including digital transformation |

## Data protection

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                    | STATUS ↗ source  | MILESTONE                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| National Data Governance and Protection Policy (decree) | IN DEVELOPMENT ↗ | Council of Ministers approved the draft decree (Politica Nacional de Governanca e Protecao de Dados) alongside decrees on interoperability and cybersecurity strategy; no confirmation on file of gazettal or entry into force |

Through 2025–26 the transitional state assembled a governance and legislative spine it had lacked: a [National Data Governance and Protection Policy](#) and a [National Cybersecurity Strategy](#), both approved by Council of Ministers decree in July 2025 alongside the interoperability regulation above, following a [January 2025 commitment](#) to create a National Cybersecurity and Data Protection Agency that is not yet confirmed established. A [revised Electronic Communications Law](#), replacing the 2010 regime, was approved with amendments by Council of Ministers but not yet confirmed passed by the transitional parliament (CNT). The CNT did enact one digital law in the period: a "[Digital Integrity](#)" law against the dissemination of false information online, passed unanimously with amendments in May 2026 and [invoked for the first time in July 2026](#) against a false claim that TikTok would be shut down nationwide. Regionally, Guinea-Bissau was named among seven states in [AUDA-NEPAD's Programme for African Developing Island Economies](#), adopted at ministerial level in July 2026 with digital transformation as one of six pillars.

## Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

*The base holds no artificial intelligence and the technology sector rows for Guinea-Bissau. A thin evidence base is a finding, not a gap in this document.*

No AI or technology-sector system is held on record for Guinea-Bissau.

## Inclusion and capacity

### Training and skills

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                              | STATUS ↗ source   | MILESTONE                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>STARTOCODE digital-skills programme (Telecel + Government)</b> | <b>PILOTING</b> ↗ | Joint decree signed creating the STARTOCODE Coordination and Monitoring Committee, formalising programme implementation |

Guinea-Bissau's only tracked skills programme is [STARTOCODE](#), a Telecel-government partnership whose coordination committee was formalised by joint decree in May 2026, targeting 1,000 youth trained annually over four years in programming, data analysis and cloud computing. [Internet penetration stood at 32.5%](#) in the last measurement held (January 2025), with no fresher survey on file.

## Finance

### New investments

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                 | STATUS ↗ source         | MILESTONE                                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>MIGA guarantee - Sonatel/Orange Bissau S.A. equity investment</b> | <b>IMPLEMENTED</b> ↗    | MIGA approved a US\$25,435,357 guarantee (FY2025) to Sonatel SA covering its equity investment in Orange Bissau S.A., part of the combined Orange Guinea/Guinea-Bissau programme |
| <b>UNDP Mais Digit@l for Guinea-Bissau grant</b>                     | <b>IMPLEMENTED</b> ↗    | UNDP committed a US\$3,360,500 grant (IATI OUTPUT 01004393) for a national digital-transformation programme implementing ENT.D.GW with UNU-EGOV technical assistance             |
| <b>World Bank WARDIP-GB (DTfA/WARDIP SOP1) IDA grant</b>             | <b>IN DEVELOPMENT</b> ↗ | WARDIP-GB programme launch ceremony presided by President Embalo in Bissau, marking the start of in-country implementation of the World Bank-financed grant                      |

Guinea-Bissau's tracked development finance is concentrated in three instruments: a [US\\$60.5m World Bank IDA grant](#) (US\$60.00m grant plus US\$0.50m government counterpart) behind the WARDIP-GB programme, approved in November 2023 and in implementation since the April 2025 launch; a [US\\$25,435,357 MIGA guarantee](#), part of a combined Orange Guinea/Guinea-Bissau programme, covering Sonatel's equity investment in Orange Bissau; and a [US\\$3,360,500 UNDP grant](#) funding ENT.D.GW's implementation, of which US\$566,152 had been disbursed at the point captured.

## Gaps to fill

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                               | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                                                                                  | LAST PROBED    |
|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>RNEP-GB / WARDIP-GB Final Report (Apr 2025)</b> | The RNEP-GB / WARDIP-GB Final Report itself, which would date and confirm the backbone design specifics (2,877 km, 56 nodes) currently resting on an undated project-website primary. | not yet probed |

The one dated absence on record is the RNEP-GB / WARDIP-GB Final Report, which would confirm the backbone's design specifics — currently resting on an undated project-website primary — and is not held as of 20 July 2026.

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.